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ROLE OF LEADERSHIP IN ENHANCING EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT IN THE EDUCATION SECTOR

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ABSTRACT:

The role of leadership in enhancing employee engagement in the education sector focuses on understanding how leadership practices improve employee engagement within educational institutions. Employee engagement is important because it affects personnel's attitudes towards their employment, their level of motivation, and the effort they contribute to their jobs. In educational institutions, both teaching and non-teaching staff play a significant role, making it essential to assess the impact authority has on their engagement levels. This study adopted a data-based approach, collecting responses through a Google Forms questionnaire from 40 employees working in different educational institutions, mainly in the Chhattisgarh region. A Simple Survey was conducted to get information. The information was identified using numerical tools like percentages, averages and correlation. The result shows that some areas, like communication and motivation were relatively weaker and need to be improved. From the response, it can be easily observed there is considerable concern among our team members regarding their role. They value themselves and receive an extra boost of motivation for working harder.

Keywords: Transformational Leadership, Leadership, Organizational Commitment, Employee Engagement, Job Satisfaction, Educational Institutions.

Introduction

Simply put, it might be stated that when people keep their work meaningful, they hence, it could be concluded that the degree of engagement among employees affects the productivity of the company and its ability to retain the employees. Initially introduced by Kahn in 1990, the term employee engagement was described as a state in where people are involved in their job responsibilities owing to the safety, significance, and value of their environment.

Styles of Leadership that influences Employee Engagement

The implementation of effective leadership is required to launch the process of engagement, and according to the type of style used, different effects might occur:

- Leadership Style Transformational represents the notion of motivation and innovation formation based on the common vision and values.
- Authentic Leadership Style highlights necessity building trust and being authentic.
- Servant Leadership Style emphasizes the development and personal growth of subordinates.

Exploring Educational Institutions

According to past research there has been lots of studies exploring the relationships between leadership styles and employee engagement, especially within the context of businesses and companies, there is scarce information on the subject in educational institutions. There are rather reasons for this clear since the educators are focused on various issues related to teaching and administration.

Conducting the Research

The research aims to identify the correlations between some leadership styles and the degree of employee engagement in an educational institution. In this case, the numerical approach was taken, and the interviews of 40 teachers were conducted in digital format. The Processing of the data collected with statistical analysis methods, the peculiarities of leadership styles fostering employee engagement will be determined. Will be willing to do it.

1. Literature Review and Research Gap

The point needs to be made that it is crucial to pay attention to the engagement of workers within any business enterprise since this parameter defines how productive and devoted employees are. High levels of engagement among workers correlated with high customer satisfaction, profitability, and low turnover rates. It is thus understandable why employee engagement cannot be considered just a part of HRM anymore but rather its crucial element.

The role of the leader as an element of motivating people is well-known to be among the most powerful. A leader motivates workers using communication, motivation, support, reward and decision-making. The theory of leadership transformational, which has been given much attention from all leadership theories because of its contribution in shaping employees' attitudes and behaviors positively, motivates workers by means of sharing vision, encouraging creativity, and offering personal support. Ghadi et al. (2013) discovered that employee engagement is positively impacted by transformational leadership because it creates a sense of purpose and aligns organisational aims with employee values. Consequently, employees become more motivated and willing to contribute beyond their basic responsibilities.

Another important leadership style linked with employee engagement is authentic leadership. Authentic leaders are transparent, ethical, self-aware, and genuine in their interactions with employees. Walumbwa et al. (2010) suggested that authentic leadership builds trust and psychological security are essential for sustained employee engagement.

Research Gap: All things considered, it is accurate to claim that the problem under consideration enjoys a lot of attention from researchers. However, the problem is often studied in the context of private companies only. Very few studies have investigated this issue in educational settings. Educational organizations function under a unique setting whereby there are special organizational objectives associated with learning activities, students, organizational structures, and public accountability. For instance, employees in these settings, whether academic or non-academic, are usually driven more by their intrinsic motivations to achieve professional success as opposed to extrinsic motives such as monetary benefits.

2. Research Design and Model

3.1.Type of Research Design

The study employs a cross-sectional, descriptive-explanatory survey design, strategically capturing comprehensive information at one particular moment in time during February 2026. This temporal scope aligns perfectly with the research objectives, as it efficiently assesses contemporary perceptions of leadership behaviours and their concurrent influence on the degree of staff participation without requiring the extended duration of longitudinal studies. The design fulfills dual analytical functions: descriptive in systematically profiling the prevalence and distribution of leadership practices (e.g., communication effectiveness, recognition frequency) alongside engagement dimensions (e.g. vigor, organizational commitment) across the sample; and explanatory in rigorously testing hypothesized causal pathways through multivariate st This study uses a quantitative and deductive research approach based on the positivist research philosophy. This approach focuses on using real data, being objective, and testing ideas

through numerical analysis. It is suitable for the research because it helps analyse the connection between managerial behaviours and staff engagement in educational institutions in a measurable and clear way.

The deductive approach is built upon existing theories, such as Kahn's (1990) notion of employee participation and Bass's (1990) transformational leadership theory. These theories are used to develop testable hypotheses for the research. The main information was received from 40 respondents using a structured questionnaire through Google Forms. After that the information was reviewed using statistical methods to understand how leadership influences engagement among teachers and administrative staff. This approach helps in drawing meaningful and reliable conclusions. Statistical techniques. Such a hybrid approach is widely recognized in organizational research as both resource-efficient and theoretically sound for exploratory studies in under-researched contexts like educational settings.

3.2. Variables Framework

Variable Type	Construct	Key Indicators	Measurement Details
Independent	Leadership Practices	Communication, supportiveness, collaboration, fairness, ethics, motivation, recognition, feedback, professional development	9 items, 5-point Likert scale
Dependent	Employee Engagement	Enthusiasm, emotional connection, extra effort, pride, retention intent	6 items, 5-point Likert scale
Control	Demographics	Age (<30 dominant), gender (mostly female), role, experience (<5 years)	Categorical

3.2.Data Collection Framework

Primary Data Collection Strategy: A structured, self-administered questionnaire was distributed through the Google Forms platform to ensure accessibility, respondent anonymity, and efficient real-time gathering information from respondents in various educational institutions.

The survey targeted staff members working in Indian universities and colleges, having a particular emphasis on respondents from the Chhattisgarh region through institutional and professional networks. 40 complete responses were successfully collected.

Instrument Composition

The questionnaire consisted of:

- 22 close-ended items based on a consistent 5-point Likert scale, ensuring psychometric reliability and consistency of responses.
- 4 demographic questions designed to capture respondent background characteristics.
- 1 open-ended question intended to gather qualitative suggestions for organizational improvement.

The collected responses were systematically compiled and converted it to excel for coding, tabulation, and subsequent statistical analysis.

Temporal Parameters: The procedure of gathering data was conducted during the period of February 4 to February 22, 2026. This timeframe ensured that the responses reflected the prevailing organizational climate, leadership practices, and employee engagement conditions within the participating institutions.

Target Population: The target population comprised teaching faculty, administrative personnel, and non-teaching staff employed across universities and colleges. These groups collectively represent the broader educational workforce in India, with particular emphasis on regional institutions within Chhattisgarh.

Sampling Technique: This approach enabled the researcher to access readily available participants through professional networks while also ensuring the inclusion of both academic and administrative employees relevant to the study objectives.

Achieved Sample Profile: The final sample of **n = 40 valid respondents** demonstrated the following demographic characteristics:

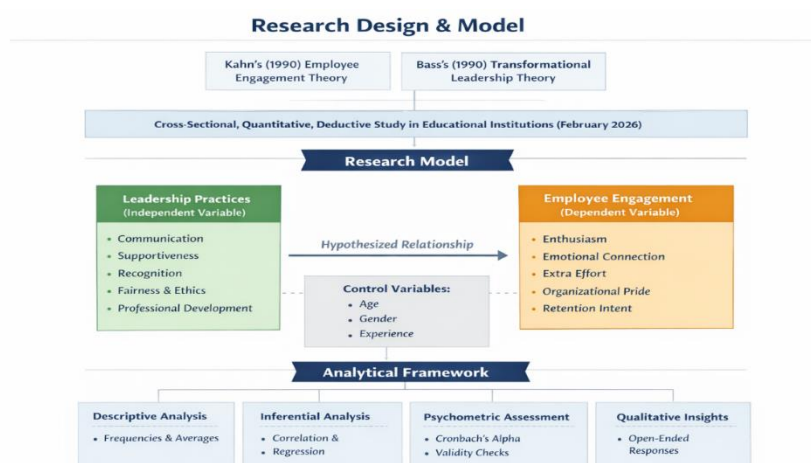
- **82%** were below the age of 30 years
- **65%** were female respondents
- **78%** had less than 5 years of organizational tenure
- Approximately **35%** represented teaching roles
- Approximately **65%** represented non-teaching roles

Methodological Rationale: The selected number of respondents was deemed suitable for exploratory research, providing sufficient statistical power to detect medium effect sizes at $\alpha = 0.05$ and **power = 0.80** in correlational analyses commonly applied in organizational behavior studies. However, the research employed a non-probability sampling technique, certain limitations regarding the credibility of findings are acknowledged.

3.3 Analytical Framework

The analytical strategy progresses through four integrated phases to ensure comprehensive examination of research questions:

- **Descriptive Analysis:** Computation of univariate are used to characterize leadership practice prevalence, engagement levels, and demographic profiles across the sample. Visual representations such as histograms, bar charts, and box plots facilitate pattern identification.
- **Inferential Analysis:** Application of bivariate Pearson product-moment correlations to quantify strength/direction of associations between leadership practice dimensions and employee engagement outcomes, complemented by multiple linear regression modelling to assess predictive relationships while controlling for demographic covariates.
- **Psychometric Assessment:** The scale was assessed via Cronbach's alpha coefficient (target threshold >0.70 per scale), ensuring robust measurement properties. Additional validity procedures encompass content validation against established literature constructs and preliminary normality assessment via Shapiro-Wilk tests to guide parametric assumption compliance.
- **Supplementary Analysis:** Basic group comparisons (independent t-tests, one-way ANOVA) exploring demographic moderation effects, alongside thematic content analysis of open-ended responses to enrich quantitative findings with contextual insights.



4. Research Methodology

The following part describes the systematic process followed to conduct the study. It explains the method, structure, gathering of information, sampling techniques, and analytical procedures used in order to investigate the connection between leadership practices and enagement of employees in educational institutions. The methodology has been designed to ensure clarity, reliability, and validity of the findings while keeping the process simple and practical within the given academic constraints.

4.1 Research Approach

The chosen methodology to conduct the research may be characterized as qualitative, implying that special attention will be paid to gathering numbers. Such a decision was made for the necessity to make an objective analysis of the variables involved. As a result, it will be possible to find some patterns, correlations, and tendencies related to the problem.

In other words, the qualitative methodology is regarded as the most appropriate choice to employ in the study because it is necessary to prove the statistical correlation between the two phenomena. Using the quantitative values of the variables, one will be able to make more objective conclusions.

Research Approach and Logical Sequence of Research Steps

Having selected the research methodology, it is possible to examine the differentiation of the research approach that should be used:

- **Theoretical Background:** In accordance with the chosen research method, the first step implies getting an understanding of various theories of both of the phenomena involved.
- **Data Collection:** Next, collecting empirical data is essential to verify their correctness.
- **Analysis and Verification:** Following such helped to conduct a theory-driven research study where the key point implies establishing connections between the two phenomena.

4.2 Research Design

The study adopts a cross-sectional survey research design.

The proposed design will be cross-sectional, implying that the researcher will conduct a single measurement during the research process at a particular moment. Some of the strengths of cross-sectional research designs include timeliness and relative cost-effectiveness due to the possibility of obtaining a snapshot.

Suitability of the Design to the Study

One can suggest several aspects explaining why this particular design is suitable for the study at hand:

- **Investigation of Current Status:** This research design enables the evaluation of the current situation in terms of leadership practices and employee engagement.
- **Perspective on Employee Attitudes:** This research design provides an opportunity to examine the perspective of the staff regarding leadership practices and organizational policies.
- **Common Research Design:** Cross-sectional research design is commonly employed and respected in social science.

Descriptive and Explanatory Aspects

The proposed research includes two key functions: descriptive and explanatory.

Descriptive: The descriptive function involves descriptive statistical techniques that help in understanding general attributes of the data collected and the nature of the survey.

Explanatory: Exploratory statistical techniques involve the identification of relationships between different variables, in other words, identifying interdependencies. In this specific case, leadership practices represent the independent variable, whereas employee engagement can be considered the dependent one.

4.3 Data Collection Method

The actual information was collected by an organized questionnaire.

For gathering the necessary data, a digital survey was created on the basis of the Google Forms platform. There were a few key factors contributing to such a choice, including saving time and simplicity in distributing and analyzing the results.

First and foremost, considering the questions are ordered similarly, all participants will be presented with identical prompts. Consequently, there is zero probability of any bias from an interviewer.

Measurement and Scaling

All but one question were asked within the framework of the five-point Likert scale.

- Strongly Disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly Agree

Using a five-point Likert scale can be very helpful while measuring respondents' subjective attitudes. By selecting the relevant option, the subject shows the level of intensity of his/her position in relation to the given statement. Hence, transformation of the subjective perception into quantitative form becomes much easier.

Questionnaire Structure

To make the results more reliable, the questionnaire was re-directed into three different sections:

- Leadership Practices: The initial section concerned employees' perceptions of different leadership techniques. Communication, encouragement, motivation, recognition, fairness, and team-building skills were addressed.
- Employee Engagement: In the second part, personal enthusiasm was evaluated. Issues related to professionalism, affiliation, and commitment were considered.
- Demographic Information: Finally, respondents were asked to provide some demographic information, specifically their age, gender, occupation (teacher/administrator), and overall experience at the school.

Benefits of Using Digital Tools for Gathering Data

However, digital data collection offered some benefits to the study, and the broadening of the scope was one of them.

4.4 Sample and Sampling Technique

The research draws on a sample of 40 responders that are now working in educational institutions. The participants included both teaching staff (such as teachers and lecturers) and non-teaching staff (such as

administrative personnel). Including both categories helped in obtaining a deeper and more thorough comprehension of employee engagement across different roles.

The majority of the responders were chosen from institutions located in the Chhattisgarh region, providing a focused context for the study. A large proportion of those involved were youthful professionals, with a large percentage having a total five years of professional expertise. This demographic is generally relevant as early-career employees are often more sensitive to leadership practices and workplace environment.

For selecting participants, a convenience sampling technique was used. In other words responders were chosen based on their availability and readiness to take involvement in the questionnaire.

In addition to convenience sampling, a purposeful sample strategy was also implemented. This made guaranteed that only people working in educational institutions were incorporated into the research. By doing so, the researcher maintained the relevance and focus of the data.

Despite that they are practical and suitable for academic research they might restrict how broadly the results can be applied with limited resources. Since the sample is not randomly selected, the findings might not highlight the exact entire population of educational employees. However, for an exploratory study, this approach is acceptable and provides useful insights.

4.5 Methods of Data Evaluation

Responses were arranged and examined using fundamental analytical methods. For additional processing, the information was imported via Google Form into Microsoft Excel spreadsheet.

The analysis was carried out in the following stages:

1. Descriptive Analysis:

- Frequencies and percentages
- Mean (average) values
- Simple charts and graphs

This step helped in understanding the general trends in leadership practices and employee engagement among respondents.

2. Inferential Analysis: In order to assess the connection between leadership practices and employee engagement, basic inferential techniques such as correlation analysis were used. Correlation helps in

identifying whether there is a positive or negative relationship between variables and how strong that relationship is.

3. **Reliability Check:** To guarantee that the questionnaire was consistent and reliable, internal coherence was evaluated via standard methods such as Cronbach's alpha (if applicable). This step ensures that the items used in the questionnaire accurately measure the intended constructs.
4. **Comparative Analysis:** Basic comparisons were made based on characteristics of the population, like age, gender, and experience to identify any differences in perceptions among different groups.

4.6 Ethical Considerations

The information was continued using appropriate ethical considerations. The survey's participation rate was completely voluntary, and respondents were informed about the study's objective. Their answers remained private, and no personal identification details were disclosed.

Utilisation of Google Forms ensured anonymity, which encouraged participants to provide honest and unbiased responses.

4.7 Restriction of the Research

Although the methodology was carefully designed, it is Important to recognize specific constraints:

- The sample size is relatively small (40 respondents).
- The Analysis is cross-sectional, meaning it captures data at a single moment in time and is not accountable for modifications gradually.

Nevertheless, despite these drawbacks, the chosen research methodology turned out to be rather appropriate for the purposes of conducting scientific studies of the phenomenon in question. The chosen method ensured that certain findings concerning the interrelationship between worker engagement ad styles of leadership would discovered.

5. Data Analysis & Findings

The data provided below is derived from the analysis conducted through the utilization of the survey questionnaire. The total number of valid answers obtained from this method is 40.

In order to make sure that the gathered data would be analyzed appropriately, the researcher performed the following statistical methods:

- Descriptive analysis aimed at describing the key characteristics of the gathered answers as well as summarizing the collected data.
- Correlation analysis used to investigate the kind of relation established between leadership behaviors and levels of engagement attained by employees.



Mean Scores of Leadership and Employee E 1

- **Descriptive Insights:**

On the whole, the behaviours of leaders can be viewed as acceptable, thus, earning medium scores of 3.84. Among the highest rated aspects are such leadership behaviours as team spirit development 4.00, personal growth 3.97, and ethical behaviours 3.92. In turn, the lowest scores are related to issues of motivation and communication 3.72.

- **Employee Engagement Levels:**

When speaking about employee engagement, they should be evaluated as rather high 3.74. high levels of involvement inked to workers' pride in their membership 3.85 and readiness to work overtime on tasks 3.82 reflect workers' desire to devote more efforts. However, lower engagement

rates related to emotional commitment 3.64 and future perspectives 3.77 suggest that it is vital to increase the engagement of workers with the company.

- Correlation Analysis:

As far as the correlation coefficient is concerned, it can be said that it is extremely high ($r = 0.83$). In other words, changes in leadership behaviours will automatically lead to desirable changes in engagement rates.

6. Conclusion and Future Scope

By focusing on the outcome of this research it can be stated that leadership does hold a positive effect on motivation, satisfaction, and loyalty of employees. Ethical leaders, who strive to assist workers in their professional growth and be committed to them, will ensure a favourable organizational climate. Speaking about the information obtained during the study, it is accurate to say that leaders operate effectively in their roles. High rates of employee engagement prove that leaders positively influence the productivity of employees through such aspects as motivation and communication. Furthermore, the relationship between the studied variables is extremely close. Effective leaders create successful organizations. Academic organizations will experience great success if they manage to introduce the leadership issue into their activities.

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